



Document Management System



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Title: Noninvasive Ventilation in PICU & HD

The use of non-invasive support is becoming widely accepted as first modality of treatment for respiratory distress for children.

Its use is associated with reduced need for intubation as well as reduced number of extubation failure.

Mechanism of action of NIV

- * Maintain lung volume during expiration
- * Decrease atelectasis and Improve oxygenation
- * Unload respiratory muscle and reduce fatigue

Indications of use of NIV:

- Respiratory distress secondary to bronchiolitis , pneumonia or congestive heart failure
- Respiratory support post extubation
- Weaning from BIPAP support
- Respiratory support to children with neuromuscular disease
- Post extubation stridor

****Please note** that for a baby with apnea on non invasive support, careful monitoring should be done in highly monitored area (PICU). You need to consider intubation in cases where the baby is unsafe (having frequent apnea, need to transfer from area to another).

Pre-requests for successful NIV

- * Appropriate interface (face mask , nasal prongs , nasal masks)
- * Adequate sedation

One can use oral medications like chloralhydrate, oral clonidine. Other options include dexmedetomidine infusion and this is to be used in PICU and require close monitoring for heart rate and level of sedation.

High flow nasal cannulae treatment (HFNC)

This is defined as delivery of blended, heated, humidified air and oxygen through nasal cannulae at flow rates higher than 2 L/min.

Flow rate can range from 2L/min to 40L/min depending on maximum flow rates available in the blender. The aim is to provide continuous distending pressure (PEEP) to unload respiratory muscles and improve work of breathing.

Contraindications to HFNC:

- Choanal atresia
- Recent surgery to nasopharynx, repair for tracheoesophageal fistula
- Recent abdominal surgery

Starting HFNC:

- Child needs to be on continuous monitoring for respiratory rate, heart rate, SpO₂ and work of breathing
- Start HFNC at 1L/kg/min, for example for a child weight 4 kg, you can start at 4L/min
- Start Fio₂ that keeps the child saturation >92%. You can set FIO₂ 0.4 to start with.
- Maximum flow is 2L/kg/min and is decided on maximum flow in blender.
- Obtain BGA or ABG 30 minutes post commencing HFNC, ensure appropriate blood gas reading

****Please note that child may have normal oxygen saturation despite hypercarbic respiratory failure**

· Monitor for features of improvement, the heart rate and respiratory rate as well as work of breathing should improve with lung recruitment

· At the end of 2 hours from commencing HFNC, decide if the treatment is working or not. Observe improvement in heart rate, respiratory rate and work of breathing

· Consider changing form of non invasive support or mechanical ventilation if there is no clinical improvement. The decision needs to be taken with the consultant for PICU or HD.

**** for children admitted in high dependency area, the child needs to be transferred to PICU if escalation of respiratory support is needed.**

Please note that we sometimes use other forms of non invasive support in HD, which will be decided by HD consultant.

· All children need to have nasogastric feeding tubes which need to be aspirated every 2-4 hours for air.

Complications of HFNC:

- Gastric distention
- Pneumothorax (rare)

Neonatal CPAP, bi-level CPAP devices

Infant flow SIPAP (fusion care)

Infant flow SIPAP provides non invasive support for small babies and infants through the use of small nasal masks or prongs.

The following modes are available on SIPAP devices:

- Start with PEEP of 6-7 cm and adjust Fio₂ according to the baby oxygen saturation.
- Ensure that there is no significant leak in the system and that the baby gets a proper level of PEEP

Other modes on SIPAP

Biphasic: time triggered pressure assists. In this mode, we can set both desired PEEP and PS

Neonatal bubble CPAP

Aim of bubble CPAP is to provide continuous positive airway pressure to allow lung recruitment

Setting bubble CPAP

- Adjust the desired PEEP level according to clinical decision. Suggested starting PEEP 6-7 cm H₂O
- The baby needs oro-gastric feeding tube for air decompression. Air should be aspirated every 2-4 hours
- Make sure that the chamber is bubbling all the times and that there is no leak in the system, this ensures positive pressure is delivered
- Ensure that there is no disconnection in the system at the time of care (avoid loss of PEEP)
- Obtain BGA or ABG 30 minutes post commencing bubble CPAP
- Consider intubation in cases the baby did not show signs of improvement after 2 hours (i.e. there are no signs of improvement in the work of breathing, presence of respiratory acidosis or Fio₂ > 50 % or PEEP > 8 with no clinical improvement)

Non invasive devices for older children (Bi-pap)

The provision of BI-PAP support includes providing EPAP and IPAP. This can be achieved using servo I ventilator or TRIOLGY.

IPAP (inspiratory positive airway pressure) is used to assist spontaneous breaths (PS). On the other hand, EPAP (expiratory positive airway pressure) is used to provide constant PEEP to keep alveoli open and stent airway.

Setting BIPAP:

- start with PEEP of 8 and PS of 10. Higher levels of PEEP of 10-12 can be considered in older children
- set Fio₂ 0.4 to keep oxygen saturation > 92%
- observe for respiratory distress, heart rate and respiratory rate
- obtain BGA or ABG 30 minutes from commencing the treatment
- look for evidence of improvement (improvement in respiratory rate, heart rate and oxygen saturation)

Contraindications to BIPAP support

- * Recent facial, upper airway surgery
- * Presence of facial abnormalities (burns, trauma)
- * Presence of vomiting
- * Recent upper GIT surgery
- * Presence of copious respiratory secretions

Predictors of non invasive ventilation failure

The following factors are associated with noninvasive ventilation failure

- *needto change forms of non invasive support
- *Presenceof respiratory acidosis with PH 7.25 after 2 hours from treatment
- *Underlyingmulti organ dysfunction

Indications of mechanical ventilation

- Failure of non invasive support
- Respiratoryarrest
- Cardiorespiratoryarrest
- Inabilityto protect the airway

Weaning from non invasive support

Weaning from non invasive support should beconsidered once the child clinical condition improves. Weaning can start after1st day of non invasive ventilation use.

If the child is on high flow nasal cannulatreatment, wean the flow gradually until the flow < 1l/kg/min where one canconsider changing the child to nasal cannula . Otherwise, PEEP can be graduallyreduced until it is minimum PEEP (newborn: 5 cm H2O, child 6 cm H2O).

In select groups of patients, consideration canbe made to change them from CPAP / BIPAP to HFNC.

References:

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
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